
HS 636: Sociology of Religion

Course Code	HS 636
Course Name	Sociology of Religion
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	PhD students, SHSS
Distribution	Elective
Approval	10th Senate (Jun 2016)

Course Contents

- **Module- I: Introduction** [6 Lectures]
 - Berger, Peter. The Sacred Canopy chapters 1-4 (pp. 3-10 I).
 - Swidler, Ann. Culture in Action, ASR 1986.
 - Weber, Max . The Social Psychology of the World Religions
 - Weber, Max. The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism
 - Geertz Clifford, Religion as a Cultural System in Interpretation of Cultures.
- **Module- II Rituals and Practices** [8 Lectures]
 - Durkheim, Elementary Forms of Religious Life, selections
 - Douglas, Preface, A Rule of Method, The Two Bodies in Natural Symbols
 - Ortner, Theory in Anthropology Since the Sixties. Comparative Studies in Society and History. 26 (1988):1, 126-66.
 - McNally, Michael. The Uses of Ojibwa Hymn Singing at White Earth: Toward a History of Practice in Lived Religion in America.
 - Rosaldo, Renato. Grief and the Headhunter's Rage Introduction to Culture and Truth.
 - Forbes, Cheryl. Coffee, Mrs. Cowman, and the Devotional Life of Women Reading in the Desert pp. 116-132 in Lived Religion in America
 - Radway, Janice. Interpretive Communities and Variable Literacies: The Functions of Romance Reading pp. 465-486 in Rethinking Popular Culture
- **Module- III: Authority and Legitimation** [10 Lectures]
 - Weber, Max The Sociology of Religion, chs.
 - Berger, Peter The Sacred Canopy chs. 5-7
 - Casanova, Jose, Public Religions in the Modern World, chs.1, 2, 6, 7.
 - Stark, Rodney. Secularization RIP Sociology of Religion 1999.
- **Module- IV: Approaches to the study of religion** [10 Lectures]
 - Classical approach: Durkheim, Marx, and Weber
 - Contemporary approach: Phenomenological, Neo Marxist, Freudian, New Functional, Anthropological
 - The insiders view: theologians and religious believers
 - Religions of the World: organized and non-organized e) Religious, economic, social, Cultural movements
- **Module - V: Religion and Contemporary Debates** [8 Lectures]
 - Religion and Modernity: Secularization Approaches to the Study of Religion

- Methods of Studying Religion
- Issues of Power and Control in Religious Organizations
- In Indian context: Communalism and Religious Mobilizations- Broadly Religion and Politics
- Globalization and Religion

Readings

1. Peter van der Veer, Gods on Earth: The management of Religious Experience and Identity in a North Indian Pilgrimage Centre, Oxford, Delhi, 1989.
2. Mark Jurgensmeyer, Religion Nationalism confronts a Secular State, OUP, Delhi, 1993.
3. A. Nandy, Trivedy, Mayararn and Yagnik, Creating a Nationality: The Ramjanrnabhoomi
4. Movement and the Fear of the Self, OUP, Delhi, 1987
5. N. K. Bose. 1994. The Structure of Hindu Society. Delhi: Orient BlackSwan.
6. T. N. Madan, Religion in India, OUP, New Delhi, 1991 .
7. Davie, Grace. (2007). The Sociology of Religion, London/New Delhi/Los Angeles/Singapore: Sage Publications.
8. Fenn, Richard K. (2003). The Blackwell Companion to Sociology of Religion, Malden/Oxford/Melbourne/Berlin: Blackwell Publishing Ltd.
9. Beckford, James A. and Demerath III, N.J. The SAGE Handbook of the Sociology of Religion, London/New Delhi/Los Angeles/Singapore: Sage Publications.
10. Robert Bellah. 1991. Beyond Belief: Essays on Religion in a Post-Traditionalist World. University of California Press.
11. Robert Bellah. 1992. The Broken Covenant. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
12. Robert Bellah. 1986. Habits of the Heart: Individualism and Commitment in American Life
13. Geertz Clifford. 1973. The Interpretation of Cultures: Selected Essays. Basic Books
14. Jose Casanova. 1994. Public Religion in the Modern World. Chicago: Chicago University Press.